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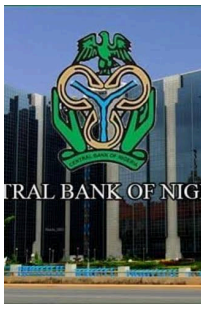


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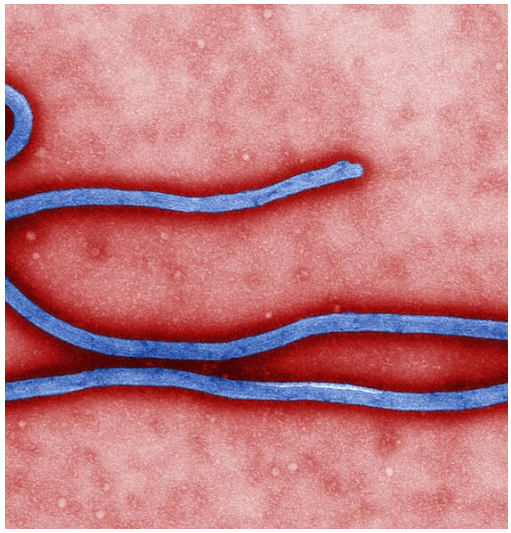
NATION

NIGERIA CONFIRMS EBOLA CASE IN ABUJA, TRACES 44 CONTACTS

A woman who flew in from Uganda has tested positive for Ebola in the FCT. She is in isolation, and health officials have identified 44 close contacts.

By Today Newspaper Staff

ABUJA — Nigeria has confirmed a case of Ebola disease in the Federal Capital Territory, twelve years after the country contained its last outbreak. The patient, a woman who recently arrived in the country on an international flight from Uganda, tested positive on Tuesday, 20 October, and is in isolation receiving treatment at a private hospital in Abuja.



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Nigeria Confirms Ebola Case in Abuja, Traces 44 Contacts

The confirmation was announced in a statement by the Coordinating Minister of Health and Social Welfare, Professor Muhammad Ali Pate, who said the Nigeria Centre for Disease Control and Prevention (NCDC) and the FCT Health Services Secretariat had begun a full public health response.

Health officials have so far identified 44 close contacts of the patient, including health workers, other patients, caregivers and people who travelled with her. The minister said the contacts have been placed under quarantine measures and are being monitored. Authorities are also working with the aviation sector to obtain flight passenger lists so that anyone who may have been exposed during the journey can be reached.

Speaking on national television on Tuesday night, Pate said the woman had no symptoms while travelling and fell ill after arriving in Nigeria. He said the virus detected was different from the Sudan and Zaire types of Ebola, that the NCDC has the laboratory capacity to identify it, and that international partners have offered support. "The government is on top of it," he said, urging travellers who have recently been in the Democratic Republic of Congo, Uganda or Kenya to give health workers an accurate travel history.

The government has asked all public and private hospitals across the country to be on high alert, to isolate any suspected case, to follow strict infection prevention and control measures, and to report suspected cases immediately. The hospital treating the patient is receiving support to strengthen its own infection control. Further updates will come from the Presidential Task Force on Ebola Virus Disease and the NCDC.

In a message on Wednesday, the NCDC urged Nigerians to remain calm and to rely only on verified information. Ebola spreads through direct contact with the blood or body fluids of a person who is sick with the disease or has died from it, or with materials contaminated by those fluids. A person cannot pass on the virus before symptoms appear.

Symptoms include fever, severe weakness, headache, muscle pain, nausea, vomiting and diarrhoea. Anyone who develops symptoms or believes they have been exposed is advised to avoid close contact with others and to call the health authorities before going to a hospital. The NCDC toll-free line, 6232, is open 24 hours a day.

The case comes as the Democratic Republic of Congo battles one of the largest Ebola outbreaks on record. The outbreak, caused by the Bundibugyo virus, for which there is no licensed vaccine, had passed 8,700 confirmed cases and 4,200 deaths by early October, according to the World Health Organization. Kenya has confirmed nine cases since early October, while Uganda recorded 20 cases between May and June.

Nigeria's 2014 outbreak began when an infected traveller arrived in Lagos from Liberia. It led to 19 confirmed cases, one probable case and eight deaths before the World Health Organization declared the country free of Ebola on 20 October 2014 — twelve years to the day before this new case was confirmed.

DSS Arraigns Five Over Kidnap of 20 Prospective Corps Members in Imo



OWERRI — The Department of State Services (DSS) on Tuesday arraigned five men before the Imo State High Court sitting in Mgbidi, Oru Judicial Division, over two kidnapping cases. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

Police Fire Tear Gas at #EndSARS Memorial at Lekki Tollgate



LAGOS — Police on Tuesday fired tear gas to disperse a memorial held at the Lekki tollgate in Lagos to mark the sixth anniversary of the #EndSARS protests. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

Gunmen Kill NSCDC Officer, Abduct Businessman in Plateau



JOS — Gunmen have shot dead an officer of the Nigeria Security and Civil Defence Corps (NSCDC) and kidnapped a businessman in Pushit community, Mangu Local Government Area of Plateau State.

The attack happened at about 9.30pm on Monday. The businessman, who trades in fuel, cement and fertiliser, was taken from the community. The NSCDC officer, a Deputy Superintendent who was not in uniform, was shot as he rode his motorcycle to buy a recharge card.

A resident, Lawrence Tabitha, said the headlight of the officer's motorcycle lit up the kidnappers as they were leaving, and they may have believed he had come to stop them. He appealed to security agencies and the state government to secure Pushit District and rescue the businessman, and listed earlier attacks in Vodni, Sabon Gari and Nchiya.

The Plateau NSCDC spokesperson, ASP AR Rimvyok, confirmed the incident.

NNPC Activates Emergency Response After Pipeline Explosion in Eleme



PORT HARCOURT — NNPC Ltd has confirmed an explosion on a gas pipeline operated by its subsidiary, NNPC Gas Infrastructure Company (NGIC), in Aleto community, Eleme Local Government Area of Rivers State. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

POLITICS

APC CAMPAIGN DENIES PLOT AGAINST ATIKU, ASKS SECURITY AGENCIES TO QUESTION TIMI FRANK



ABUJA — The All Progressives Congress (APC) Presidential Campaign Council has denied claims that the government plans to assassinate former Vice President Atiku Abubakar, the presidential candidate of the African Democratic Congress (ADC).

In a statement on Tuesday, the council's spokesperson, Dele Alake, urged security agencies to invite Timi Frank, an ADC member and former deputy national publicity secretary of the APC, to substantiate the allegation. In an open letter dated 19 October, Frank had appealed to United States President Donald Trump, as well as the United Nations, African Union, ECOWAS, the European Union and the United Kingdom, alleging that state institutions could be used to intimidate, arrest or harm Atiku.

Alake said Atiku remains protected by the Nigeria Police Force and the State Security Service, and denied that his security had been withdrawn. He said President Bola Tinubu had directed security agencies to strengthen protection for presidential, vice-presidential, governorship and deputy governorship candidates ahead of 2027, and that Atiku also enjoys state-funded security as a former Vice President.

He described Frank's claim as opposition rabble-rousing meant to heat up the polity and urged campaigners to make responsible statements.

Senate Re-passes Raw Materials and Procurement Bills After Tinubu's Observations

The Senate has passed revised versions of two bills returned by the President after a legal review found drafting errors.

Plateau Assembly Approves State Police Bill

The Plateau State House of Assembly has voted for the constitutional amendment that would allow states to set up their own police.

Baba-Ahmed Accuses Tinubu Government of Neglecting the North

PRP National Chairman Hakeem Baba-Ahmed says the administration has neglected northern states; Kaduna's information commissioner says Tinubu will win in 2027.

Afenifere Leader Pa Reuben Fasoranti Dies at 100

AKURE — Pa Reuben Famuyide Fasoranti, leader of the pan-Yoruba socio-political group Afenifere, has died at the age of 100. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

Zamfara Lawmakers Say Constituents Will Decide Their Next Move After Tinubu Meeting

Eight Zamfara lawmakers who left the APC say they have not agreed to return to the party, despite meeting President Tinubu at the Villa.

Obi Clarifies Remarks Urging Diaspora Nigerians Not to Send Money Home

NDC presidential candidate Peter Obi says his words to UK-based supporters were twisted and that he never asked anyone to abandon their families.

Abiodun Suspends Eselu of Iselu Over Alleged Partisan Politics

ABEOKUTA — Ogun State Governor Dapo Abiodun has suspended Oba Akintunde Akinyemi, the Eselu of Iselu Kingdom in Yewa North Local Government Area, with immediate effect. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

NDC Accuses APC of Luring Its Candidates With Cash and Appointments

The Nigeria Democratic Congress says candidates who defected to the APC were never true members and will be replaced through fresh congresses.

ECONOMY

NNPC CUTS EXPLORATION SPENDING BY 87%, GAS FLARE BILL FALLS TO N499BN



ABUJA — Spending by NNPC Ltd on new exploration fell by 87.7 per cent in 2025, from N640.5 billion in 2024 to N78.8 billion, according to the company's latest audited financial statements.

The report shows gas flaring charges fell by 62.2 per cent to N499 billion, made up of N247.8 billion in flare fees and N251.2 billion in penalties. The fees are charged under Section 104 of the Petroleum Industry Act when operators exceed limits approved by the Nigerian Upstream Petroleum Regulatory Commission.

NNPC paid N11.56 trillion in royalties, rentals and flare obligations during the year, compared with N2.83 trillion in 2024. Helped by a N1.18 trillion write-back of excess provisions, its outstanding liabilities in this area fell by 86.2 per cent to N1.27 trillion. Royalty charges rose 4.1 per cent to N4.66 trillion, and the levy paid to the Niger Delta Development Commission rose 29.2 per cent to N514.7 billion.

Group revenue fell by 23.4 per cent, from N45.08 trillion to N34.52 trillion. The three state-owned refineries are carried in the books at a combined N2.72 trillion.

The drop in exploration spending comes as work in frontier basins such as Kolmani, in Bauchi and Gombe States, has slowed. Under Executive Order 9 of 2026, President Bola Tinubu moved the 30 per cent Frontier Exploration Fund from NNPC to the Federation Account.

Stock Market Loses N1.47trn as Capitalisation Falls Below N160trn

The NGX All-Share Index fell 0.91 per cent on Monday as profit-taking in Dangote Cement and other stocks wiped N1.47trn off the market.

New Tax Law: 25% Is the Top Rate, Not a Flat Charge on All Earnings

A claim by Senator Ireti Kingibe that the new tax laws make everyone pay 25 per cent of their earnings is not supported by the Nigeria Tax Act.

Domestic Debt Service Hits N5.28trn in First Half of 2026

Debt Management Office figures show Nigeria spent N8.61trn servicing domestic debt in 2025 and N5.28trn in the first six months of 2026.

Africa Needs $115bn to Develop Its Gas, Says GECF Chief Mshelbila

The Secretary General of the Gas Exporting Countries Forum says Africa must invest up to $115bn in gas infrastructure between 2031 and 2040.

Black-Owned Businesses in Nigeria Face $131bn Funding Gap, Report Says

A study by British International Investment and Swedfund puts Nigeria's funding gap for Black-owned and -led businesses at $131bn, the highest of five countries.

JP Morgan Moves Closer to Nigerian Banking Licence After N50bn CBN Deposit

JP Morgan Chase has reportedly deposited N50bn with the Central Bank of Nigeria, one of the last steps before a merchant banking licence.

FG Orders Faster Rollout of One Million CNG Vehicles

The Minister of State for Petroleum (Gas), Ekperikpe Ekpo, has directed agencies to speed up the conversion and deployment of one million CNG-powered vehicles.

Keyamo Approves Design for Monorail to Lagos Airport

A five-station monorail will link Ikeja Railway Station on the Lagos Red Line to Murtala Muhammed International Airport.

EDUCATION

HARDSHIP AND HIGHER SCHOOL FEES KEEP NASARAWA PUPILS AT HOME



LAFIA — Five weeks into the new academic session, some pupils in Nasarawa State have yet to return to school as parents struggle with rising fees and the cost of living.

In Lafia, the state capital, school-age children were seen on the streets during school hours on Monday morning. Some private schools have reportedly raised fees by more than 30 per cent, and some pupils who had resumed were sent home over unpaid fees.

A civil servant, Paul Dangana, said his children would stay at home until his October salary was paid. A POS operator, Nuhu Jalal, said he had to save extra money to pay his children's higher fees on time.

Private school owners blamed multiple taxes and levies from the state and local governments, as well as rising running costs, and said fees are their main source of income. A former Majority Leader of the Nasarawa State House of Assembly, Abdulhamid Kwarra, urged parents to enrol their children in schools they can afford rather than keep them at home.

Lagos City College Class of 1976 Marks 50 Years With Support for School



LAGOS — The 1976 graduating set of the Lagos City College Old Students' Association (LACCOSA) is marking 50 years since leaving school with a week of events and new support for their alma mater. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

NTI Centre Managers Suspend Strike After Deal on Unpaid Allowances



KADUNA — The National Centre Managers' Forum of the National Teachers' Institute (NTI) has suspended the warning strike it began on 12 October over unpaid allowances. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

Senate Backs Bill to Boost Funding for Unity Colleges and Armed Forces Schools



ABUJA — A bill to amend the National Senior Secondary Education Commission (NSSEC) Act passed second reading in the Senate on Tuesday and was referred to the Committees on Primary and Secondary Education. *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

Two Arraigned for Impersonating JAMB Registrar



ABUJA — Two men, Arinze Nwogba and Sunday Nweke, have been arraigned before the Federal High Court in Abuja on charges of impersonating the Registrar of the Joint Admissions and Matriculation Board (JAMB). *(Full story at todaynewspaperng.com)*

ENTERTAINMENT

DANGOTE AGREES TO APPEAR ON ISBAE U'S 'CURIOSITY MADE ME ASK'



LAGOS — Industrialist Aliko Dangote has agreed to appear on "Curiosity Made Me Ask", the YouTube interview and comedy show hosted by comedian Adebayo Abidemi, known as Isbae U.

The exchange took place on Monday when Isbae U visited the Dangote Refinery in Lagos during an event tagged "Vision 2030", and a video of it spread widely on Tuesday. The comedian told Dangote that his past interviews were on platforms young people do not watch, noting the interest young Nigerians have shown in the company's planned share offer. Dangote promised to come on the show.

In the video, Dangote said his generation had not done well enough for Nigeria and Africa, and remarked that most young Nigerians know little about former President Shehu Shagari. He also recalled meeting boxing legend Muhammad Ali in Washington as a boy, in the company of his grandfather.

Past guests on the show include former President Olusegun Obasanjo, actor Richard Mofe-Damijo and veteran actor Pete Edochie.

Aproko Doctor, Taaooma, Layi Wasabi Among Creators at PluggedIN 2026



LAGOS — Content creators including Aproko Doctor, Taaooma, Layi Wasabi, Osas Ighodaro, Biodun Stephen, Bolaji Ogunmola and Shank Comics are billed to feature at PluggedIN 2026, an event that brings creators together with brands and advertising agencies.

The second edition holds on 22 October in Victoria Island, Lagos, and will be hosted by actress Bisola Aiyeola. It is organised by Woof Studios Africa with Insight Redefini, a Publicis Groupe affiliate. Panellists include Craze Clown, Jay On-Air, Kiekie and Winifred Nwania, alongside marketing executives from several consumer brands.

The organisers say more than 1,500 Nigerian YouTube channels had over 100,000 subscribers in 2024, but that more than half of Nigerian creators still earn less than $100 a month. The first edition, in 2025, was held with YouTube.

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